

# Top 10 Offspeeds in the 2027 Draft

Fastballs establish a pitcher's ceiling. Breaking balls often define a pitcher's identity. Offspeed pitches, however, separate starters from throwers.

Throughout the evaluation of 53 draft-eligible college pitchers, no pitch type was more consistently associated with starter projection than the changeup and splitter. While high-end fastballs and breaking balls drove much of the attention throughout this series, the pitchers with the strongest long-term rotation outlooks almost always possessed an answer for opposite-handed hitters. More often than not, that answer came in the form of a high-quality offspeed pitch.

Across the database, seven changeups and three splitters earned grades of 60 or better, a remarkable total for a single draft class. Some generated swing-and-miss through velocity separation. Others relied on exceptional movement profiles, unusual spin characteristics, or advanced command. Regardless of how they achieved it, the best offspeed pitches consistently disrupted timing, neutralized platoon disadvantages, and allowed pitchers to navigate lineups multiple times.

What makes this group particularly impressive is its variety. There are traditional fading changeups, low-spin parachutes, power splitters thrown with fastball intent, and several offerings that blur the line between the two. Some function primarily as chase pitches. Others are capable of stealing strikes early in counts and generating weak contact even when hitters anticipate them.

In an era increasingly dominated by velocity and breaking-ball design, the ability to throw an elite offspeed pitch remains one of the most valuable traits a starting pitcher can possess. The pitchers featured below have developed offerings that already project as professional weapons and, in many cases, serve as the foundation of their starter projections.

These are the ten best offspeed pitches in the 2027 college pitching class.

## Number 10: Max Stammel, LHP, Virginia, Changeup (55)

Metrics: 80.3 Velo | 7.4 IVB | -20.9 HB | 2230 RPM

Key Trait: Massive arm-side fade paired with significant velocity separation creates one of the most difficult changeups in the class to square up.

Stammel's changeup earns a place on this list because of its extreme movement profile. Featuring over 20 inches of arm-side movement and over 10 mph of separation from his fastball, the pitch consistently forces hitters into uncomfortable contact points. Rather than relying on pure depth, the offering succeeds through overwhelming lateral movement, creating a true fade profile that continually moves away from barrels.

What makes the pitch particularly effective is how dramatically it changes the movement picture for hitters. The fastball works on a much different plane, allowing the changeup to appear competitive before veering sharply arm side late in flight. That movement regularly pulls barrels off the baseball and forces hitters to either reach for the pitch or swing over the top of it.

The velocity band further enhances the effectiveness. Sitting around 80 mph, the pitch offers enough separation from the fastball to disrupt timing while still maintaining the arm speed necessary to sell the offering. Hitters are often caught between gearing up for the fastball and waiting back for the changeup, resulting in weak contact and uncomfortable swings.

The shape is somewhat uncommon among the changeups in this article. While several pitches ranked above it rely on dead-zone characteristics, splitter action, or unusual vertical movement profiles, Stammel's offering succeeds through pure fade. The movement is significant enough that hitters frequently know the pitch is coming yet still struggle to make quality contact.

Why #10: Stammel's changeup features some of the most extreme arm-side movement in the 2027 class and gives him a legitimate professional offspeed weapon. The pitches ranked above it offer either greater overall impact or more advanced utility against both handedness groups, but few changeups can match the sheer amount of fade created by this offering.

## Number 9: Dax Whitney, RHP, Oregon State, Changeup (55)

Metrics: 87.7 Velo | 4.0 IVB | 12.3 HB | 1400 RPM

Key Trait: Hard kick-changeup shape with exceptional depth off the fastball and advanced conviction locating it beneath the zone.

Whitney's changeup is often overshadowed by his elite fastball and slider, but it remains one of the best offspeed pitches in the class. Thrown at nearly 88 mph with low spin and substantial movement separation from the fastball, the pitch creates a dramatically different look while maintaining enough velocity to prevent hitters from comfortably adjusting. The result is a true kick-changeup profile capable of generating empty swings against both sides of hitters.

What makes the offering particularly effective is the way it pairs with Whitney's fastball. Hitters are forced to gear up for upper-90s velocity and a riding fastball that attacks the top of the strike zone. The changeup emerges from a similar release before rapidly losing vertical carry and fading beneath barrels. The movement differential creates a difficult visual transition for hitters, frequently forcing commitment before the shape fully reveals itself. The pitch is not simply a show-me offering used to keep hitters honest. Whitney consistently demonstrated confidence throwing it below the strike zone and expanding for chase when ahead in counts. The conviction behind the pitch allows it to function as a legitimate weapon rather than a complementary third offering, and the shape consistently creates uncomfortable contact points even when hitters recognize it.

The low-spin characteristics are particularly intriguing. At just 1400 RPM, the pitch maintains the tumbling action evaluators seek from a high-end changeup while still carrying enough velocity to remain competitive against advanced hitters. That combination gives the offering significant professional value and helps round out one of the most complete arsenals in the class.

Why #9: Whitney's changeup benefits from one of the elite fastball foundations in the country, but the pitch stands on its own as a quality professional offering. The pitches ranked above it either feature more extreme movement profiles or serve as a larger driver of their respective arsenals, but Whitney's changeup remains one of the better offspeed pitches in the 2027 class.

## Number 8: Cameron Bagwell, RHP, Wake Forest, Changeup (55)

Metrics: 84.2 Velo | 0.6 IVB | 15.0 HB | 1520 RPM

Key Trait: Hard downward action plays exceptionally well within a vertically aligned arsenal and consistently generates chase beneath the zone.

Bagwell's changeup is the defining pitch of his arsenal and one of the best pure depth changeups in the 2027 class. Thrown in the mid-80s with minimal carry and 15 inches of arm-side movement, the pitch features hard late tumble while maintaining enough velocity to remain difficult for hitters to distinguish from the fastball. The shape consistently pulls barrels beneath the baseball and creates uncomfortable swing decisions against hitters from both sides of the plate.

What makes the offering particularly effective is its location profile. Bagwell routinely demonstrated the ability to throw the changeup down and arm side to both hands, allowing the movement to work at maximum effectiveness. The command is strong, and even when the pitch leaked higher in the zone, the results remained excellent. Opponents produced a 52% ground-ball rate and just an 83 mph exit velocity, illustrating how difficult it was to elevate or square up.

The pitch served as Bagwell's primary weapon against left-handed hitters during the 2026 season, accounting for roughly 29% usage as part of a four-pitch approach that made sequencing particularly difficult. Rather than functioning solely as a chase pitch, the changeup consistently generated swings throughout counts, forcing hitters to respect the offering as a true weapon.

Perhaps the strongest indicator of the pitch's effectiveness is how often hitters chose to swing. Bagwell's changeup generated a 58.5% swing rate while producing a 47.9% chase rate beneath the strike zone. Those numbers highlight both the deception of the pitch and how effectively it mirrors the fastball out of hand before separating late in flight.

Why #8: Bagwell's changeup combines velocity, tumble, command, and deception into one of the better offspeed weapons in the class. The pitches ranked above it feature either more extreme movement profiles or greater overall impact, but few changeups generate this combination of chase, weak contact, and swing commitment.

## Number 7: Camden Clark, RHP, Southern Miss, Changeup (55)

Metrics: 83.9 Velo | 8.1 IVB | 12.8 HB | 1740 RPM

Key Trait: A movement profile that closely mirrors the fastball creates exceptional deception and forces hitters to commit before recognizing the pitch.

Clark's changeup earns its place on this list because of how effectively it disguises itself. Unlike many elite changeups that rely on extreme movement separation from the fastball, Clark's offering maintains a remarkably similar movement profile while arriving nearly 10 mph slower. The result is a mirror effect that forces hitters to commit to the fastball path before realizing they are tracking an entirely different pitch.

The pitch possesses enough arm-side movement to avoid barrels while maintaining carry characteristics that keep it visually competitive deep into flight. Rather than immediately revealing itself through exaggerated fade or tumble, the changeup spends a long time looking like a fastball before gradually separating. That delayed recognition is one of the defining characteristics of many successful professional changeups and helps explain why the pitch consistently generated swing-and-miss despite lacking the eye-popping movement profiles of some offerings ranked above it.

Clark demonstrated confidence throwing the pitch in virtually any count and against either handedness. It consistently functioned as a weapon against left-handed hitters while also serving as a reliable secondary against right-handed hitters. The combination of deception, movement, and command allowed the pitch to generate both empty swings and weak contact without needing extreme shape.

Why #7: Clark's changeup may not possess the outrageous movement characteristics of the pitches ranked above it, but few offspeed offerings in the class create deception as effectively. The ability to mirror the fastball while maintaining quality velocity separation gives the pitch a strong professional foundation and one of the more projectable changeups in the 2027 class.

## Number 6: Noah Wech, RHP, Oklahoma State, Changeup (55)

Metrics: 86.9 Velo | 6.6 IVB | 8.5 HB | 1200 RPM

Key Trait: Low-spin shape with late downward bite and advanced command beneath the strike zone creates a premier chase pitch.

Wech's changeup is the defining pitch of his arsenal and the primary reason he projects as a professional starter. Thrown at nearly 87 mph with an exceptionally low 1200 RPM spin rate, the pitch creates a different movement profile than most changeups in the class. Rather than relying on extreme fade or massive velocity separation, it succeeds through late tumble, deception, and consistent location beneath the strike zone.

The results were outstanding. The pitch generated a 47.8% chase rate, 46.4% whiff rate, and 28.7% swinging-strike rate, placing it among the most effective offspeed pitches in the dataset. Wech consistently trusted the offering against both right-handed and left-handed hitters, using it as a primary finishing pitch rather than simply a complementary weapon. What makes the changeup especially effective is how long it mirrors the fastball. The offering stays on a competitive trajectory deep into flight before the low-spin characteristics begin to take over, creating uncomfortable swing decisions and frequent empty swings beneath the barrel. Hitters often recognize the pitch too late to adjust, resulting in chase beneath the zone or contact made off the end of the bat.

The command further elevates the pitch. Wech routinely located the changeup in ideal areas beneath the strike zone, allowing the movement profile to operate at maximum effectiveness. Rather than depending solely on raw shape, the pitch consistently appeared where hitters were most vulnerable, turning a quality offering into a legitimate out pitch.

Why #6: Wech's changeup combines elite swing-and-miss production, low-spin characteristics, and advanced command into one of the best offspeed pitches in the class. The pitches ranked above it offer either more unique movement profiles or a greater overall carrying tool, but few changeups in college baseball generated better pure results in 2026.

## Number 5: Duke Stone, RHP, Miss. State, Splitter (55)

Metrics: 87.3 Velo | 2.3 IVB | 9.7 HB | 1190 RPM

Key Trait: Late tumble and heavy downward action paired with enough arm-side movement to create uncomfortable swing decisions from both handedness groups.

Stone's splitter rounds out one of the most complete four-pitch arsenals in the class and gives him a legitimate weapon against both right-handed and left-handed hitters. Thrown around 87 mph with exceptionally low spin, the pitch features heavy late tumble and enough arm-side fade to disrupt barrels while maintaining the velocity necessary to remain difficult to identify out of hand.

The splitter plays particularly well off Stone's riding fastball. Hitters are forced to respect the vertical characteristics of the heater before the splitter abruptly drops beneath the barrel, creating a dramatic movement contrast despite coming from the same release window. Against left-handed hitters, the arm-side fade creates uncomfortable contact points, while against right-handed hitters the depth becomes the primary weapon.

What separates the pitch from many splitters at the collegiate level is its versatility. Stone uses it throughout counts rather than reserving it exclusively as a two-strike weapon, and the movement profile consistently generates weak contact when hitters stay on it. The pitch produced a 58% ground-ball rate and regularly prevented hitters from lifting the baseball, allowing it to function as both a chase pitch and a contact-management tool.

Why #5: Stone's splitter combines velocity, movement, and versatility into one of the most complete offspeed pitches in the class. The pitches ranked above it possess either more dominant movement profiles or greater out-pitch characteristics, but few offspeed offerings generate this combination of weak contact, ground balls, and opposite-handed utility.

## Number 4: Wylan Moss, RHP, UCLA, Changeup (60)

Metrics: 81.3 Velo | 12.4 IVB | 17.8 HB | 2170 RPM

Key Trait: A uniquely lateral changeup with exceptional arm-side movement and command creates one of the most unusual offspeed pitches in the class.

Moss' changeup is the best pitch in his arsenal and one of the most unique offspeed offerings in the 2027 class. Thrown around 81 mph with over 11 mph of separation from the fastball, the pitch features massive arm-side movement while maintaining far more carry than a traditional fading changeup. The result is a movement profile that behaves more like a UFO crossing the plate than a conventional changeup, moving laterally for an unusually long period before reaching the hitting zone.

What makes the pitch particularly effective is how consistently Moss locates it. He routinely works the offering down and arm side to hitters from both sides of the plate, allowing the movement profile to play at maximum effectiveness. Against right-handed hitters, the pitch runs aggressively toward the hands and produces weak contact. Against left-handed hitters, the movement carries the ball away from barrels, creating difficult swing decisions and frequent empty swings.

The results were exceptional when executed. Opponents hit just .157 against the changeup during the 2026 season, and the pitch generated a 35% put-away rate when used in finishing situations. The movement profile consistently prevented hitters from squaring up the baseball and gave Moss a legitimate out pitch against either handedness.

Few changeups in the class create this type of movement profile. While many elite offspeed offerings generate value through depth, Moss succeeds primarily through extreme lateral action. The pitch simply looks different than what hitters are accustomed to seeing, helping it stand out among an already talented group of changeups.

Why #4: Moss' changeup combines elite movement, strong results, and advanced command into one of the most distinctive offspeed pitches in the class. The pitches ranked above it possess slightly greater overall impact, but few offerings create a more uncomfortable visual for hitters than this one.

## Number 3: Casan Evans, RHP, LSU, Splitter (60)

Metrics: 82.6 Velo | 3.5 IVB | 12.1 HB | 1430 RPM

Key Trait: A low-spin splitter with heavy downward bite that routinely drops beneath the zero line and generates elite swing-and-miss.

Evans' splitter is the foundation of his arsenal and arguably the best strike-generating offspeed pitch in the class. Thrown in the low-80s with substantial arm-side movement and late tumble, the pitch consistently arrives at the bottom of the strike zone before disappearing beneath barrels. The shape allows Evans to attack hitters aggressively while still generating chase and whiff at an elite clip.

The production was exceptional. The splitter generated a strike nearly 70% of the time while producing a 52% whiff rate and 31.7% swinging-strike rate, leading to 79 total whiffs during the 2026 season. Few offspeed pitches in the class combined strike-throwing ability and swing-and-miss production as effective as Evans. The ability to consistently start the pitch in the zone before finishing beneath contact points created difficult decisions for hitters throughout the season.

What separates the pitch from many other splitters is its reliability. Evans routinely commands it to the lower half of the strike zone, allowing the movement profile to work at maximum effectiveness. Even when hitters made contact, the results were typically weak and on the ground due to the late, downward finish. The pitch functions as both a strike-getter early in counts and a put-away weapon when Evans needs a punchout.

There is still room for growth. At times the splitter can lose some of its bite and hang up. However, the pitch just as often drops beneath the zero-IVB threshold and flashes truly elite finishing action. Continued consistency in the movement profile could elevate the pitch from a plus offering into one of the premier professional splitters in amateur baseball.

Why #3: Evans' splitter combines elite swing-and-miss production, strike-throwing ability, and weak-contact generation into one package. The pitches ranked above it offer either greater movement uniqueness or more complete overall profiles, but few offspeed pitches in the class generate outs as consistently as this one.

## Number 2: Ryan McPherson, RHP, Miss. State, Splitter (60)

Metrics: 88.4 Velo | 4.4 IVB | 12.0 HB | 1130 RPM

Key Trait: Premium velocity and late vertical bite allow the pitch to mirror the fastball before disappearing beneath barrels.

McPherson's splitter is the defining secondary in his arsenal and one of the most professional-ready offspeed pitches in the class. Thrown at nearly 89 mph with exceptionally low spin, the pitch combines premium velocity with late tumble, creating a movement profile that remains difficult to identify until it is too late for hitters to adjust. The offering consistently mirrors the fastball out of hand before abruptly dropping beneath contact points, generating uncomfortable swing decisions against both right-handed and left-handed hitters.

What separates the pitch from many collegiate splitters is its command. McPherson already demonstrates advanced feel for landing the pitch beneath the strike zone rather than simply burying it and hoping for chase. That ability allows the splitter to function as both a strike-generating weapon and a finishing pitch, keeping hitters honest throughout an at-bat while still producing swing-and-miss when needed.

The movement profile also creates significant weak contact when hitters stay on the pitch. Rather than producing only empty swings, the splitter frequently generates soft ground balls due to the late downward action and velocity differential off the fastball. The pitch remains competitive long enough to induce commitment before the tumble takes over and shifts the barrel beneath the baseball.

The importance of the splitter to McPherson's long-term projection cannot be overstated. The pitch already serves as the separator within the profile and is the primary reason evaluators can project a future starter outcome rather than a high-leverage relief role. Continued gains in command consistency and movement replication would elevate the offering even further and provide a realistic pathway toward becoming a true plus major league splitter.

Why #2: McPherson's splitter combines velocity, deception, command, and professional utility into one of the most complete offspeed pitches in the class. Only one offering in the 2027 group creates a more unique movement profile while maintaining this level of effectiveness.

# Number 1: Tanner Bradley, RHP, Oregon, Changeup (65)

Metrics: 78.5 Velo | -4.3 IVB | 21.8 HB | 2190 RPM

Key Trait: Elite arm-side movement and depth from a low release create one of the most unique movement profiles in the class.

Bradley's changeup is the defining pitch of his arsenal and the clear choice for the top offspeed offering in the 2027 class. Averaging just under 79 mph with over 21 inches of arm-side movement and negative induced vertical break, the pitch produces a movement profile rarely seen at the collegiate level. The combination of velocity separation, depth, and fade consistently forces hitters into awkward swing decisions and makes the pitch exceptionally difficult to square up.

The production was dominant. Bradley's changeup generated a 62.5% whiff rate, 30.8% swinging-strike rate, and 48.9% CSW, making it one of the most productive pitches in the entire database regardless of classification. Unlike many collegiate changeups that function primarily as platoon weapons, Bradley showed complete trust in the pitch, throwing it in any count and against either handedness. The confidence to deploy it in virtually any situation only amplified its effectiveness.

What separates the offering from the rest of the class is the movement profile. The pitch combines extreme arm-side action with legitimate depth, creating a shape that attacks hitters in multiple directions simultaneously. Coming from a lower release, the changeup enters on an uncomfortable angle before continuing beneath barrels and off contact points. The result is a pitch that regularly generates swings over the top of the baseball despite hitters often sitting change.

The changeup also serves as the central piece connecting the rest of Bradley's arsenal. The sinker and sweeper are both quality offerings, but the changeup is what gives the profile its identity. The movement separation off both pitches forces hitters to defend the entire strike zone and prevents them from committing to a single movement pattern.

Why #1: Bradley's changeup combines elite movement, elite results, elite usage, and true professional out-pitch characteristics. No offspeed pitch in the 2027 class generated a more dominant combination of whiffs, chase, and uncomfortable contact. It is a genuine plus-plus weapon and the best offspeed pitch in the class.